2025–26 Program Evaluation

Tidepath Family Alliance · Prepared by Coral Ridge Evaluation Partners · June 2026

Summary

Coral Ridge Evaluation Partners, an independent evaluator, reviewed all three of Tidepath Family Alliance's programs for the 2025–26 school year: Anchor Mentors, family counseling, and the Safe & Strong school workshops.

In the 2025–26 school year Tidepath reached 1,340 students through school workshops, 186 youth in mentoring matches, and 212 families in counseling. 81% of families we serve earn below 200% of the federal poverty level, and 58% speak Spanish or Haitian Creole at home.

All three programs met or exceeded the targets set in Tidepath's strategic plan. The main risk we found is capacity: demand for family counseling grew faster than therapist hours, and waits returned in the spring.

Methods

Every workshop series used pre- and post-surveys of participating students. Partner schools shared attendance and enrollment data every quarter. We interviewed 24 mentors, 31 parents and caregivers, and 9 school counselors, and reviewed counseling intake and closing assessments.

Anchor Mentors

Anchor Mentors pairs youth ages 10 to 17 with screened, trained adult volunteers who meet weekly for at least 12 months. Of the 186 youth in mentoring matches, 141 reached the one-year mark, and the average match lasted 19 months.

Of youth matched for a full year, 92% stayed enrolled in school and 74% improved their school attendance. Mentees missed an average of 6 fewer school days than in the year before they were matched.

Mentors cited the monthly group outings as the main reason they stayed. Matches that attended at least six outings were twice as likely to reach the one-year mark.

Family counseling

Licensed family therapists provided free short-term counseling of 8 to 12 sessions at both family centers and by telehealth, in English, Spanish, and Haitian Creole. Telehealth accounted for 41% of sessions, up from 22% the year before.

Families who completed counseling reported a 38% average drop in household conflict, and 89% said they knew where to turn for help afterward. The average wait for a first session fell from 10 weeks to 3 weeks after two therapists joined in October 2025.

Safe & Strong school workshops

Safe & Strong reached 1,340 students in grades 4 to 12 across 14 partner schools. After the six-session series, 86% of students could name a trusted adult to go to for help, up from 61% before it began.

Students who completed the series were also more likely to report knowing what to do if they were bullied online: 79% after the series, up from 48% before.

Recommendations

- Add therapist hours before expanding counseling to new schools, so waits stay under four weeks.
- Keep telehealth as a standing option; families in the southern part of the county use it most.
- Continue the Parent Connect pilot and measure caregiver outcomes with a short pre- and post-survey.
- Track mentor retention by recruitment source to focus volunteer outreach.